

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 10

♥ Q 7

♦ Q J 9

♣ K J 9 6 3

♠ 9 6 3

♥ A K 2

♦ A 4 3

♣ A 7 5 2



♠ Q 8

♥ J 10 9 8 4

♦ K 8 7 2

♣ Q 10

♠ A 7 5 4 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 10 6 5

♣ 8 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

All Pass

1NT by North

♥s than in one of the minors. And, in ♥s you have 2 stops. So don't hold up.

You need 2 additional ♠ winners, but dummy has but one entry. So?

So you must duck twice. Win the ♥K and play a low ♠ from each hand. A defender will win and probably continue ♥s.

Win the ♥A and play another low ♠ from each hand. East wins and cashes 3 ♥s. He then plays the ♣Q.

You win the ♣A and take the ♦A and the 3 good ♠s in dummy. The 4 high cards from your hand plus the 3 ♠ tricks from dummy add up to 7. Hallelujah.

They say 1NT is the hardest contract to make. (whoever **THEY** are).

But since they may be right you need to be on the lookout for ducking plays because one entry in dummy may be all you are going to have.

Here is the question. Is 2♠ a better contract than 1NT? If so, you should transfer partner, then pass. If not, you should just pass now. With just a 5-card suit, and with no singleton, pass is probably better.

The contract would be 1NT played by South.

North plays 1NT. East leads the ♥J and West plays the ♥Q.

Do you hold up or not?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

Outside ♠s you have 6 combined cards in each suit, so you must assume that you aren't any worse off in

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 5
 ♥ Q 6 5
 ♦ Q 8 2
 ♣ A 9 8 6 3

♠ 9 7 4

♥ J 10 7 2

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ 7 2



♠ A 10 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 7 5

♣ K Q J 4

♠ K Q J 6 3

♥ K 9 4

♦ K J 10

♣ 10 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	Pass	1NT	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 5 :: Total = 8

You need to find one winner and it seems that it must come from one of dummy's red Queens. You are certain that South has both red Kings for his opening bid, (you and dummy have 26 HCP between you so that only leaves 14). But you also know that South has at least 5 ♠s, so if you lead toward a red Queen South will grab his red King plus 4 ♠ tricks.

Does that resolve the holdup question for you?

Yes. You hold up **ONCE**, and take the ♠A at trick 2. Next you play ♣ K Q J to strip South of that suit. Then play the ♠10 to throw South into the lead.

He can take his other 3 ♠ winners, but after that he must lead a red card. Of course you confidently put up dummy's Queen which will be your ninth trick.

Hold ups are designed to disrupt enemy communication.

Here you couldn't afford to hold up twice because then you would not have a throw in card left to put South on lead.

But you had to hold up on the first trick to make sure North couldn't gain entry in the suit.

By the way, if South had a 6-card suit this plan wouldn't work. But then, no other plan would either.

It is good to be a little bold with your overcalls. But with a suit this tattered and only two outside Queens this is not good enough for a 2-level overcall. So you pass. Then you hear partner say 1NT.

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A 1NT overcall shows 15-18 points and a stopper(s) in their suit. With 9 points you invite with 2NT and partner bids the game.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♠K. Do you hold up twice? Or just once? Or not at all?